

30. Agent Frameworks Compared

Frontmatter

video_number: 30
folder_title: Agent_Frameworks_Compared
series: Building an AI Business From Scratch
video_type: Comparison / Decision Guide
hook_type: Reframe hook -- wrong debate, right framework
framework_phrase: Stability, control, cost
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Reference Videos

- n8n vs Claude Code (Agentic Workflows) -- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XmzJhShHMnI>
- n8n vs Claude Code: I Tested Both So You Don't Have To -- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yfwO1PgSiZ8>
- Claude Managed Agents Just Dropped, And It Kills n8n -- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ob5Vu-gD3mo>

The One Thing

The right agent framework depends on how often the task changes and how much control you need -- not on which tool is newest or which YouTube channel covers it most.

Hook

n8n, Claude Code, Hermes, OpenClaw, LangChain -- everyone's arguing about which one to use. Here's why the debate misses the point, and the three questions that actually decide the answer.

Target Viewer

Builders who've seen the n8n-vs-Claude-Code debate and need to make a real decision for a real project -- someone who's been through the series and wants to synthesize the tools into a decision framework.

Payoff

After watching, the viewer can answer the three decision questions for any new project and map their answer to the right framework -- and they understand why having multiple frameworks in their stack is valid, not confused.

Beat Structure

Beat -- 1 -- Why the Debate Misses the Point

Point: The n8n vs Claude Code debate treats them as substitutes. They're not -- they're optimized for different task types. Using the wrong frame for the comparison makes every opinion on both sides

wrong.

Visual: Venn diagram: n8n home turf vs Claude Code home turf vs overlap zone

Target words: false substitute, different optimization, home turf, wrong frame

Beat -- 2 -- The Three Real Variables

Point: Task stability (does this task change every week or is it fixed?). Control need (do you need to see and edit every step?). Maintenance cost (who maintains this in 6 months?).

Visual: Three-variable grid: high/low stability + high/low control + maintenance owner

Target words: task stability, control need, maintenance cost, three variables

Beat -- 3 -- n8n's Natural Home

Point: n8n is ideal when the task is stable, the workflow needs to be auditable by non-developers, and the integration layer is webhook/API heavy -- client-facing automations, CRM triggers, scheduled reports.

Visual: n8n workflow screenshot: stable task, visual audit, webhook trigger

Target words: n8n, stable task, visual audit, webhook, CRM

Beat -- 4 -- Claude Code and Agentic Frameworks' Home

Point: Claude Code, Hermes, and OpenClaw shine when the task is variable, the agent needs to reason about edge cases, and the workflow changes faster than you can redraw a flowchart.

Visual: Claude Code terminal: variable task, reasoning output, edge case handling

Target words: Claude Code, variable task, reasoning, edge case, Hermes, OpenClaw

Beat -- 5 -- Multi-Framework Stack

Point: The most effective builders use n8n for stable integrations and Claude Code or Hermes for reasoning-heavy work -- the stack is not a choice between frameworks, it's a combination based on task type.

Visual: Architecture diagram: n8n layer (integrations) + Claude Code layer (reasoning) + Hermes (async persistence)

Target words: multi-framework, integration layer, reasoning layer, async layer

Analogy Bank

- n8n vs Claude Code: like choosing between a pipe wrench and a Swiss army knife -- they're not competing for the same job. The pipe wrench is better at pipes. The Swiss army knife goes everywhere. [concept: not substitutes]
- Task stability: like building with LEGO vs wet concrete -- n8n is wet concrete (set it and it hardens). Claude Code is LEGO (reconfigurable any time you need). [concept: what drives framework choice]

Thesis Line Location

Beat 2 -- the three variables are the core framework; n8n and Claude Code examples are just the most visible proof of why task stability is the key variable.

Framework Phrase

Stability, control, cost

Specificity Bank

- n8n -- best for stable, webhook-heavy, auditable workflows; strong for CRM/scheduling integrations
- Claude Code -- best for variable, reasoning-heavy tasks; changes faster than a flowchart can capture
- Hermes -- adds persistence and skill-building for async, recurring knowledge work
- OpenClaw -- best when local system access is required and task is well-defined but complex
- Multi-framework stack: n8n (integrations) + Claude Code (reasoning) = most common production pattern in 2026

Constraints

- Do not declare a winner -- the whole point is that 'winner' is the wrong frame
- Do not cover LangChain, AutoGen, or CrewAI in depth -- too much ground; acknowledge they exist but stay in the series' tool set
- Keep the decision framework to the three variables -- resist adding more

CTA Direction

Next video: the final video in the series -- here's the full AI coding setup that ties everything together, the stack Daniel actually uses daily, and how to build yours.

Personal Angle

[DANIEL TO FILL] -- e.g. the project where you built an n8n workflow and rebuilt it in Claude Code 3 weeks later because the task kept changing, and what you learned from doing both

Vulnerability Moment

[DANIEL TO FILL] -- e.g. the time you picked Claude Code for something that would have taken 20 minutes in n8n, because it was the tool you were most excited about at the time